

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 81

By Lynn

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Abigail Whicker, state winner of the 2024 American Legion Department of Tennessee Oratorical Contest.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to pay tribute to those students who, through their natural talents and unflagging commitment to excellence, have distinguished themselves as academic achievers; and

WHEREAS, Abigail Whicker, a senior at Mt. Juliet Christian Academy and a representative of the Tyler Cates Post 281, is one such exceptional student, who was recently named the state winner of the American Legion Department of Tennessee Oratorical Contest; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to academic competition, Ms. Whicker has won the 5th District Contest, the Central Division Contest, and the State Level Oratorical Contest in both 2023 and 2024; and

WHEREAS, having won the American Legion Department of Tennessee Contest, she then advanced to the semifinal round at the national event for the past two years; and

WHEREAS, Abigail Whicker is active in the arts at Mt. Juliet Christian Academy, where she participates in dance, theatre, and music programs, and she has engaged with her community through Youth Leadership Wilson; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Whicker's election as president of her school's National Honor Society chapter gave her the opportunity to help organize a goal-surpassing diaper drive for the Pregnancy Care Center; and

WHEREAS, she also serves as president of the Middle Tennessee Ag Academy FFA Chapter, which has allowed her to pursue her passions and to enroll in dual credit agriculture classes through Middle Tennessee State University; and

WHEREAS, one of the highlights of Abigail Whicker's high school career has been attending the Tennessee Governor's School for the Agricultural Sciences at the University of Tennessee at Martin last summer, and she is also thrilled to be representing Middle Tennessee FFA as the organization's 2024-2025 Regional Vice President; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Whicker first found her niche in public speaking through her participation in FFA, and she was the state winner for the FFA Prepared Public Speaking Leadership Development Event in 2024 with her speech about the PRIME Act; she went on to represent Tennessee in this event at the FFA National Convention this past October, where she was honored to be among the top eight in the nation who were named as Gold Emblem finalists; and

WHEREAS, Abigail Whicker has also honed her communication skills through competitive horse evaluation, and she and her FFA horse-judging team are the reigning state champions; and

WHEREAS, after earning a generous amount of scholarship funds through these events, she plans to attend college here in her home state; Ms. Whicker is currently preparing to run for a state officer position with Tennessee FFA, and she sees agriculture advocacy and shaping public policy as part of her future; and

WHEREAS, Abigail Whicker also loves writing music and leading worship, and she hopes to raise a family and perhaps have a farm someday; and

WHEREAS, her noteworthy achievements are a tremendous source of pride for her parents, John and Robin Whicker, her school, and her community, and she is clearly deserving of our respect, admiration, and commendation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Abigail Whicker on her selection as the state winner of the 2024 American Legion Department of Tennessee Oratorical Contest and wish her every continued success in the future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.